First Congregational Church of St. Albans (FCC) is a welcoming community of spiritual seekers, believers, and doubters.

Please know that no *matter who you are or where you are on life's journey, you're welcome here.*

First Congregational Church Vision Statement

To create an open and loving community that encourages a joyous exploration with God.
To work together to care for and nurture the wider community.

First Congregational Church Mission Statement

Our mission as a community resource church is to provide a safe place for spiritual exploration and personal growth. To affirm the value of each person and to meet them where they are.
To connect to the community through personal service, giving, and pastoral care.

Please feel free to contact us:
Administrative Office: Mon & Friday: 10-12, Tues & Thurs: 8-2
Monica will be out of the office July 10-13.
Church Office Phone Number: 802-524-4555
Pastor Jessica's Office Hours: T-W-F, 9am-12pm
Email: pastorjessica@firstcongregationalstalbans.org
For urgent, pastoral matters outside of regular office hours, call Pastor Jessica at 207-632-5544.

Our worship service is broadcast over the local public access channel 1079 on Sundays at 4 PM.

Scripture Reader: Rev. Jessica Moore

UNITED CHURCH OF CHRIST

First Congregational Church of St. Albans

An open and affirming community.



"We welcome you and serve all through faith."

Worship with us:

July, 9, 2023

9:00am

Rev. Jessica Moore, Pastor
Stephan Conrady, Organist
Monica Newton, Office Manager
27 Church Street, St. Albans, VT 05478
802-524-4555

info@firstcongregationalstalbans.org
www.firstcongregationalstalbans.org

WE GATHER AS GOD'S PEOPLE

CENTERING WORDS:
"I have always found that mercy bears richer fruits than strict justice." — Abraham Lincoln

THE PREPARATION

The beginning of the prelude is a call to enter into the spirit of prayer and community.

PRELUDE *Summertime* (Arr. S. Conrady) G. Gershwin

WELCOME AND ANNOUNCEMENTS

MORNING PRAYER[1] **(LITANY)**

O God of Heaven and Earth, who is glorified in the wisdom of children—the experts of presence and oneness. May we evoke your humble heart within us. May we wonder what it might mean to feel our exhaustion *and* your love, at the exact same time. May we consider all you've tried to show, give, or say to us that we weren't yet ready for. Prepare our souls to yoke with yours, to share in the Good News that revives every living thing. We ask this in your name and energy, Amen.

WELCOME TO ALL VISITORS: We are delighted that you chose to worship with us today and are strengthened by your participation in our service!
If you are new to First Congregational Church of St. Albans, please sign the guest book in the narthex (main entrance of the church).
If you would like more information about our church and its programs, or would like to receive our Morning Reflections and weekly e-newsletter, "From the Manse," please fill out a Welcome Card and place it in the Offering tray (be sure to include your email address).

After the service please join us for fellowship, conversation, coffee, and refreshments.

*PLEASE STAND IF YOU ARE ABLE

[1]FROM UCC WORSHIP WAYS

MUSIC, COPYRIGHT PERMISSIONS: CCLI #4799426 AND SJMP #14586

Volunteers Wanted for the Church Street Festival:



HYMN*

"***Be Now My Vision***" (1-3) NCH 451

PRAYER OF CONFESSION[1]

Spirit of God, you are always among us, and yet at times we don't notice or get caught up in our judgments. Not recognizing you in the stranger on the street or the stranger in me—who does not do the things I want, but rather the things I hate. Perhaps we thought our certainty would keep us safe or ignorance would keep us pain-free, but you show us the way of trust and awareness is what paves the path of peace. Forgive and help us, O God, by the power grace and connection. Amen.

PAUSE FOR REFLECTION

WORDS OF ASSURANCE

PASSING OF THE PEACE

THE MESSAGE

SPECIAL MUSIC *PIXLEY'S SONG* S. CONRADY

SCRIPTURE READING

GENESIS 24:34-38; 42-49

MATTHEW 11:16-19; 25-30

MORNING REFLECTION: ***DECEPTIVELY SIMPLE***

HYMN*

"***Jesus Shall Reign***" (1, 4, 5) NCH 300

THE THANKSGIVING

SHARING OUR JOYS AND CONCERNS

CHORAL CALL TO PRAYER:

Hear Our Prayer, O Lord D. Welpton

PASTORS' PRAYER~

LORD'S PRAYER

Our Father who art in heaven, hallowed be thy name. Thy kingdom come, thy will be done, on earth as it is in heaven. Give us this day our daily bread. And forgive us our trespasses, as we forgive those who trespass against us. And lead us not into temptation, but deliver us from evil. For thine is the kingdom and the power and the glory, forever, Amen

CHORAL RESPONSE TO PRAYER

"Thou wilt keep him in perfect peace, whose mind is stayed on Thee." Scottish Psalter, 1615

OFFERTORY

DOXOLOGY

Praise God from whom all blessing flow
Praise God all creatures here below;
Praise God above, all heavenly hosts:
Creator, Christ and Holy Ghost. Amen.

OFFERTORY PRAYER

THE DEPARTURE

HYMN*

"***Precious Lord, Take My Hand***" NCH 472

BENEDICTION

POSTLUDE *VOCALISE* (ARR. S. CONRADY) S. RACHMANINOFF

ANNOUNCEMENTS:

A Special Note of Gratitude From All of Us At FCC:

- Stephen McLaughlin Thank You for being our guest preacher!

The beautiful flowers on the altar are given in the loving memory of Doris Hughes from Mara Vijups.

July 16:
Church Street Community Worship
10am in Taylor Park:
"Reflections on Home"
Church Street Community Worship:
FCC, St. Paul's, St. Luke's
Special Guests: Barry Lampke from Housing For All: Working Communities Challenge and David MacCallum from Franklin/grand Isle Habitat for Humanity

Save-the-Date
August 12th Cookout at the Beeman's in Fairfax!

Bible Study
Is on break for the summer.